BATTLETECH™



QUICK-START RULES

CATALYST game labs™

INTRODUCTION

It is the 31st century, and endless wars rage across human-occupied space. These epic clashes between star empires are won and lost by BattleMechs®, 30-foot-tall humanoid metal titans bristling with lasers, autocannon and other lethal weapons. Your elite force of MechWarriors® drives these juggernauts into battle, proudly holding your faction's flag high to expand the power and glory of your realm. Will you become a legend, or a forgotten casualty?

Only your skill and luck will determine your fate!

QUICK-START RULES

These Quick-Start Rules will hurtle you onto the battlefields of the 31st century in minutes—simply read through the rules, then set up the game as shown in the *Scenarios* section (see p. 11).

SEQUENCE OF PLAY

A *BattleTech* game consists of a series of turns. During each turn, 'Mechs on the map may move and fire their weapons. Each turn consists of several smaller segments of time, called phases, which are performed in the following order:

- Initiative Phase
- Movement Phase
- Weapon Attack Phase

INITIATIVE PHASE

One player from each side rolls 2D6 to determine their side's Initiative. The side with the higher result has won Initiative throughout the turn. Re-roll all ties.

MOVEMENT PHASE

The side that lost Initiative moves their 'Mech first. The side that won Initiative moves their 'Mech second. Each time it is a player's turn to move a 'Mech, the "move" can be for it to stand still.

WEAPON ATTACK PHASE

The side that lost Initiative declares any attacks the 'Mech will make, specifying which weapons will be fired and at which target(s).

The side that won Initiative then does the same.

Each time a player must declare an attack, the declaration can be not to fire any weapons.

RESOLVING WEAPONS FIRE

Players resolve weapons fire one 'Mech at a time. The order in which each 'Mech's shots are resolved is up to that 'Mech's controller. All weapon attacks by one 'Mech should be resolved before those of the next 'Mech.

DETERMINING DAMAGE

Players record damage as attacks are resolved, but this damage does not take effect until the end of this phase. This means a 'Mech can make its declared attacks even if that 'Mech or its weapons are destroyed during this phase.

END OF GAME

Players repeat the steps above until one side meets its victory conditions for the scenario. If a specific scenario is not being used, the side with the last surviving 'Mech(s) on the map wins. If the last 'Mechs from each side are destroyed simultaneously, the game is a draw.

ADVANCED TECHNOLOGY

This Quick-Start Rules (QSR) manual will guide you through introductory games of *BattleTech*, with the express intent of keeping things fast and simple. The next step from here is the *A Game of Armored Combat* box set, which adds more 'Mechs and greater rules depth, for more complex but more tactically rewarding games. Most content found in this QSR manual is mirrored in *A Game of Armored Combat*, but in a more complex form.

However, on occasion you will note a rules section marked with: ✦. This indicates items not found in *A Game of Armored Combat*. Full rules for these items (and many more) are instead found in the *BattleMech Manual*. This way, you can have a taste of the new technologies to be found in more advanced *BattleTech* products, without getting bogged down with too many rules at the start.

MOVEMENT

(MOVEMENT PHASE)

During the Movement Phase of each turn, players must choose one movement mode for each 'Mech they control: standing still, walking, running, or jumping.

MOVEMENT MODES

At the beginning of each 'Mech's movement, a player must select one (and only one) of the following movement modes.

STANDING STILL

If the player declares that a 'Mech will stand still, the 'Mech stays in the hex in which it started the turn. It can expend no MP during that turn and cannot move or change facing. Standing still provides no penalty to the 'Mech's own weapons fire, nor that of any other 'Mechs which attack it.

WALKING

If the player declares that a 'Mech will walk, it may expend a number of MP up to its Walking MP rating. A walking 'Mech suffers a +1 Target Number modifier when making attacks. A walking 'Mech may also be harder to hit. These combat effects appear on the Attack Modifiers Table found on page 8 and are further explained under *Firing Weapons*, page 6.

RUNNING

A 'Mech can move farther in a turn when running than walking. However, a 'Mech cannot move backward while running.

If the player declares that a 'Mech will run, it may expend a number of MP up to its Running MP rating. A running 'Mech suffers a +2 Target Number modifier when making attacks, but its speed may make it harder to hit. These combat effects appear on the Attack Modifiers Table found on page 8 and are further explained under *Firing Weapons*, page 6.

JUMPING

A 'Mech that possesses Jumping MP may select this movement mode and expend up to that many MP. A jumping 'Mech suffers a +3 Target Number modifier when making attacks, but will be harder to hit. These combat effects appear on the Attack Modifiers Table found on page 8 and are further explained under *Firing Weapons*, page 6.

Jumping features numerous exceptions to the basic movement rules; see *Jumping Movement*, on page 6.

MOVEMENT BASICS

After being assigned a movement mode, a 'Mech then spends up to the Movement Points (MP) provided. A 'Mech need not spend all available MP, but no matter how few are spent, the 'Mech's movement mode does not change. MP unspent at the end of the phase are lost.

FACING

Every hex on the map has six sides, and every 'Mech must face one of those six hexsides: this is known as its facing. A 'Mech faces the way its feet are pointing.

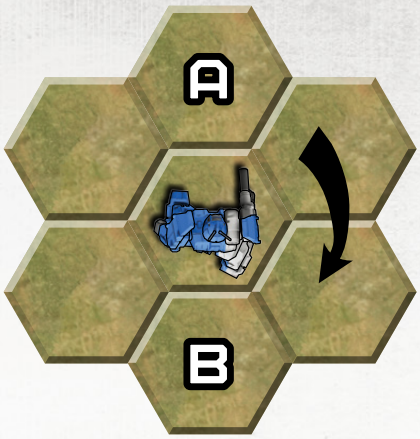
Changing facing costs 1 MP per hexside. For example, in the Facing Change Diagram on page 3, a 180-degree turn (three facings, from Hex A to Hex B) costs 3 MP.

MOVING BETWEEN HEXES

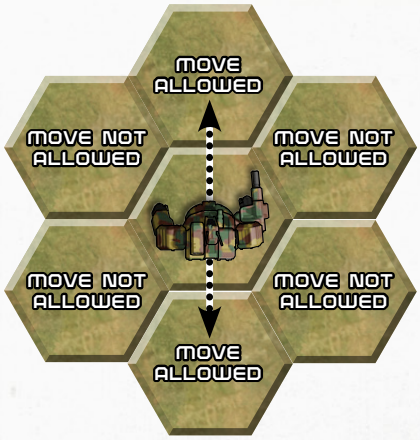
A 'Mech can move forward into the hex it is facing, or backward into the hex directly to its rear. It cannot move into any other hex without first changing its facing, as shown on the Movement Direction Diagram on page 3.

Backward Movement: A 'Mech can only move backward with Walking MP. A walking 'Mech can move both forward and backward in the same turn.





• FACING CHANGE DIAGRAM •



• GROUND MOVEMENT DIRECTION DIAGRAM •

MOVEMENT COSTS TABLE

Movement Action/Terrain Type	MP Cost Per Hex/ Terrain Cost
Cost to Enter Any Hex	1
Terrain Cost When Entering Any New Hex	
Clear	+0
Light Woods	+1
Heavy Woods	+2
Additional Movement Actions	
Facing Change	1/hexside

MOVEMENT DICE

Movement dice help players remember which 'Mechs moved and in what way. While not required, it is highly recommended that players use this rule, and the remainder of these rules assume they are doing so.

Commonly, white dice are used to mark 'Mechs that walked, black dice those that ran, and red dice those that jumped. The number displayed on the die is the Target Number generated as a result of the move, with "6" traditionally indicating a modifier of 0 (it only moved 0-2 hexes). The move cannot be changed once a movement die is placed.

It's best to use dice of a different size and/or color than those used for rolling attacks, to prevent confusion. After all weapon fire is completed, remove all movement dice from the board.



JUMPING MOVEMENT

Jumping features numerous exceptions to the movement rules.

A jumping 'Mech can move 1 hex for each available Jumping MP, regardless of terrain. A 'Mech may jump into the same hex it began the turn in for 1 MP.

A jumping 'Mech ignores terrain (and the presence of other 'Mechs) in hexes it jumps through. However, it cannot land in a hex containing another 'Mech. A jumping 'Mech also ignores facing: it can jump in any direction regardless of its initial facing, and chooses any facing desired upon landing.

TERRAIN

All hexes cost at least 1 MP to enter. However, terrain often raises this MP cost, as shown on the Movement Costs Table (see p. 3). For example, entering a Heavy Woods hex costs 3 MP: the base 1 MP for entering any hex (the distance travelled), and 2 MP more for the Heavy Woods (to navigate through the trees).



CLEAR

Clear terrain represents fields, meadows and other grasslands. The ground is firm and may be gently rolling, but its height does not change significantly from one side of the hex to the other.

If a hex is not clearly marked as another terrain type, assume it is Clear.



LIGHT WOODS

Light Woods hexes are covered with sparse trees. 'Mechs cannot cross the hex as easily as Clear terrain (hence the +1 MP cost). Three intervening hexes of Light Woods will block LOS (see *Intervening Terrain*, at right).



HEAVY WOODS

Heavy Woods hexes are thickly covered in trees, making movement even more difficult (the +2 MP cost) than Light Woods. One Light Woods and one Heavy Woods hex intervening will block LOS (see *Intervening Terrain*, at right).

STACKING

A 'Mech cannot move through a hex occupied by an enemy 'Mech (friendly 'Mechs are fine), nor end its movement in a hex occupied by any other 'Mech.

COMBAT

(WEAPON ATTACK PHASE)

After all players complete the Movement Phase, their 'Mechs engage in combat.

For one 'Mech to fire at another, the attacking 'Mech must have a valid line of sight to the target, and the target must be within the range and firing arc of the weapons the attacking player wishes to use. The attacking player then calculates the Target Number needed to hit the enemy based on several factors: Gunnery Skill, attacker movement, target movement, other modifiers such as those for terrain, and range. (See the *G.A.T.O.R.* sidebar, p. 6.)

FIRING ARC

The first part of making attacks is ensuring that a target lies in the attacking 'Mech's firing arc, as shown on the Firing Arc Diagram on page 5. The firing arc extends from the firing 'Mech to the edge of the playing area. Any target outside the firing arc cannot be attacked.

LINE OF SIGHT

In order to attack a target, a clear line of sight (LOS) must exist between the target and the attacker. A straight line running from the center of the attacking 'Mech's hex to the center of the target 'Mech's hex defines the LOS between two 'Mechs. Any hexes this line passes through lie along the LOS, even if the line barely crosses the corner of a hex.

If the LOS passes exactly between two hexes, the player controlling the targeted 'Mech decides which of the two hexes lie along the LOS. The chosen hex is used for LOS of all attacks between those two 'Mechs for the remainder of the turn. If this choice means you lose LOS, you can look for another target.

The hexes containing the attacking and target 'Mechs are *not* considered when determining LOS.

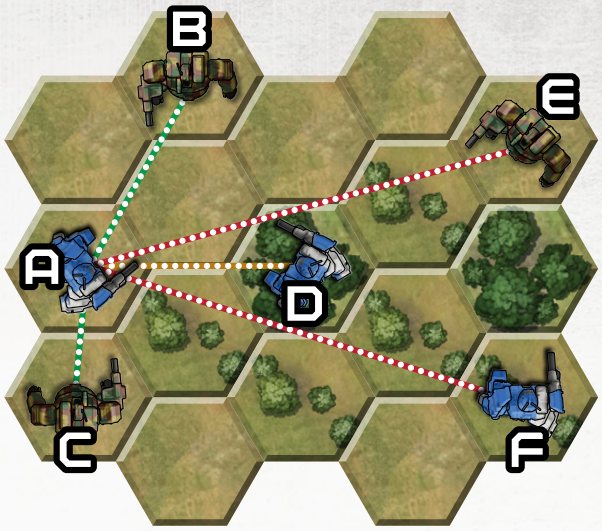
INTERVENING TERRAIN

Terrain along the LOS between the attacker and the target is called intervening terrain. This does *not* include the hexes occupied by the attacker and target.

Woods: Three or more points of intervening woods block LOS. Each Light Woods hex is worth 1 point, and each Heavy Woods hex is worth 2 points.

INTERVENING 'MECHS

Intervening 'Mechs have no effect on LOS or attacks.



• LINE OF SIGHT DIAGRAM •

EXAMPLE

As line of sight is so important, the Line of Sight Diagram, left, includes numerous 'Mechs to best illustrate its principles. The 'Mech in Hex A wants to make an attack. Checking LOS for the 'Mech in Hex A to the other 'Mechs, we find the following conditions.

'Mech A has clear LOS (green lines) to the 'Mechs in hexes B and C, as there is no intervening terrain. However, C is not in Mech A's firing arc.

LOS to the 'Mech in Hex D (yellow line) passes directly between a clear hex and a light woods hex. The target player thus gets to choose which affects the LOS, and naturally chooses the light woods. This choice does not block LOS, however, because woods in a target hex are never intervening. They make the target harder to hit, but they don't affect LOS.

LOS to the 'Mechs in hexes E and F is blocked (red lines) because there is at least one hex of light and heavy woods intervening.

You can use the diagram to practice finding LOS to the other 'Mechs. Try to determine how many targets each 'Mech can see, and compare your results to the correct results that follow: Hex B has four targets, Hex C has three targets, Hex D has five targets, Hex E has three targets, and Hex F has two targets.



• FIRING ARC DIAGRAM •

ATTACK DECLARATION

After you've determined if you can see your target, you then declare attacks. As described in *Sequence of Play* (see p. 1), all attacks are declared before any are resolved. However, an attack may be aborted if the modified Target Number is greater than 12; see *Rolling To Hit*, p. 9). Players may not make attacks they have not previously declared.

WEAPON ATTACKS

During the Weapon Attack Phase, players use their 'Mechs' armament to attempt to inflict damage. The rough order of such actions is as follows:

- The attacker rolls to see if a weapon they declared as firing hits the declared target 'Mech;
- If the weapon hits, the attacker rolls a hit location;
- The targeted player marks off in that location a number of armor circles equal to the amount of damage inflicted;
- If a location is destroyed and damage from the attacking weapon remains, that damage is transferred to the next location inward;
- This procedure repeats until all weapons fire is resolved.

Players fire each weapon on a 'Mech individually. Each weapon can normally be fired only once per turn, and only gets one to-hit roll per turn.

Ultra Autocannons: These rapid-fire weapons can optionally be fired twice in a turn. Only roll once to see if you hit, even if you fire two shots. If you hit with both, see *Determining Hit Location* on page 9 for how to resolve this.

AMMUNITION EXPENDITURE

If a weapon uses ammunition—noted on the record sheet under "Ammo Type"—the player marks off one shot of ammunition (and only one, no matter the weapon) in the 'Mech Data section of the appropriate record sheet when they announce an attack with that weapon. A weapon out of ammunition can no longer be fired.

Streak Missiles: If your attack with one of these weapons misses, don't mark off a shot (no ammunition is used).

Ultra Autocannons: If one of these weapons is fired twice in a turn, it uses two shots.

FIRING WEAPONS

Players use their 'Mechs' armament to attempt to inflict damage on targets. Each weapon is always fired individually, even if the 'Mech has multiples of the same weapon in the same location.

MAKING THE ATTACK

When making an attack, use the G.A.T.O.R. sidebar, below, to create a final Target Number. Then roll 2D6 to see if the attack hits the target. If the result is equal to or greater than the modified Target Number, the attack hits.

If the modified Target Number is greater than 12, the shot automatically misses; rolling a 12 does not result in an automatic hit. If a player determines that their 'Mech's declared attack will automatically miss, they can choose not to make the attack, though another target may not be chosen in its place.

If the modified Target Number is 2 or less, the shot automatically hits.

Resolution Order: The attacker chooses the order in which they make attack rolls for all of their 'Mechs' declared attacks. This order can change from turn to turn, even if the 'Mech fires the same weapons at the same target.

G.A.T.O.R.

The attack process is not complicated—simply a matter of rolling 2D6 and trying to equal or exceed your modified Target Number. However, the "modified" part—juggling all those numbers—can be tricky.

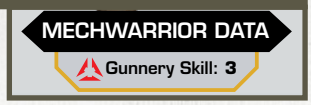
After you understand the Target Number Modifiers section starting above, you'll find that "GATOR" is a helpful mnemonic that reminds you what needs to be taken into account:

- **G** Gunnery Skill Rating of the attacker (the base Target Number for the attack). Then add:
- **A** Attacker movement modifier [the color of the Movement Die on your 'Mech]
- **T** Target movement modifier [the number on the Movement Die on the target 'Mech]
- **O** Other modifiers
- **R** Range modifiers

Start with your Gunnery Skill rating, then add all other applicable modifiers, and the result is your modified Target Number to meet or exceed on the die roll. In the Target Number Modifiers section (as well as the Attack Modifiers Table), modifiers are listed in GATOR order.

BASE TARGET NUMBER (GUNNERY SKILL)

GATOR



The base Target Number for a weapon attack is the pilot's Gunnery Skill. For these Quick-Start Rules, unless specifically stated otherwise, that base Target Number is 4 for Inner Sphere MechWarriors and 3 for Clan MechWarriors (it is printed on each record sheet).

TARGET NUMBER MODIFIERS

The base Target Number may be modified by several factors, including movement, terrain (woods) and range. All modifiers are cumulative, and are listed on the Attack Modifiers Table (see p. 8).

ATTACKER MOVEMENT MODIFIER

GATOR

An attacker that moves has a harder time hitting its target. The attacker movement modifier is based on the movement mode the attacker used that turn (Walking +1, Running +2, or Jumping +3). The actual MP the attacker expended or distance they moved is irrelevant. The color of the Movement Die on the attacking 'Mech gives you this modifier, *not* the number.

TARGET MOVEMENT MODIFIER

GATOR

A moving target is harder to hit. The target movement modifier (often called "TMM") is based on the number of hexes traversed by the target this turn, not the amount of MP it spent (the number on the Movement Die on the target 'Mech, *not* the color). For the precise modifiers, see the Attack Modifiers Table on page 8.

If the target moved both backward and forward in the turn, base the modifier on the number of hexes moved from the hex in which the 'Mech last reversed its movement. For example, if the target moved backward three hexes and then forward two hexes, its target movement modifier would be based only on the final two hexes of movement, resulting in a modifier of 0 (its Movement Die would show a 6, meaning no modifier).

A 'Mech that jumped this turn automatically raises its target movement modifier by 1 (in addition to whatever modifier it had due to the number of hexes it moved). For example, a 'Mech that walk or ran 5 hexes would have a target movement modifier of +2, but if it jumped 5 hexes, this would be +3 instead.

PULSE MODIFIER

GATOR

Pulse lasers are more accurate than standard weapons. If the weapon being fired is a pulse laser, apply a –2 Target Number modifier to its attack.

TERRAIN MODIFIERS

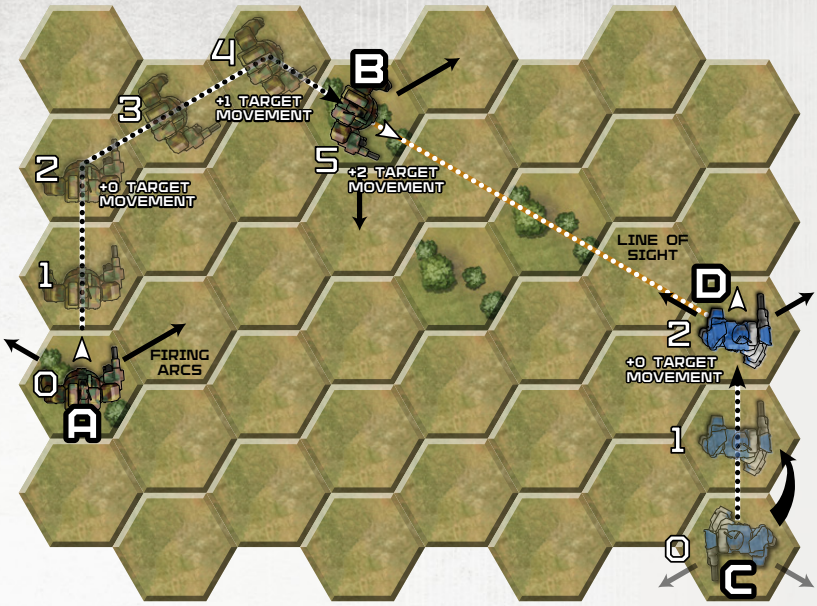
GATOR

Terrain in the way of an attack reduces the chance of a successful shot.

Light Woods: Add a +1 modifier to an attack's Target Number if the target is in a Light Woods hex. Also apply a +1 modifier per hex of Light Woods intervening between the attacker and target (see *Intervening Terrain*, p. 4).

Heavy Woods: Add a +2 modifier to an attack's Target Number if the target is in a Heavy Woods hex. Also apply a +2 modifier per hex of Heavy Woods intervening between the attacker and target (see *Intervening Terrain*, p. 4).

Remember that three or more points of intervening woods block LOS—Light Woods are worth 1 point, and Heavy Woods are worth 2 points. In other words, you cannot add more than a +2 modifier for intervening terrain, or else LOS is blocked. Also remember that the hex a target is in is never intervening: it can apply a Target Number modifier, but it doesn't affect LOS.



• ROLLING TO HIT DIAGRAM •

RANGE MODIFIER

GATOR

The farther away a target is, the harder it is to hit. Taking the shortest path, count the number of hexes between the attacker and the target, including the target's hex. The total is the range to the target.

Each weapon's range is divided into range brackets: short, medium, and long. For example, as shown above, a Long Range Missile (LRM) launcher has a range of 21 hexes. Its short-range bracket is "7," meaning that any attack made with LRMs against targets 1-7 hexes away is in the LRM's short range.

The range bracket a target is in determines the range modifier for an attack with that weapon against that target. A short-range shot does not modify the attack's Target Number. A medium-range shot adds a +2 Target Number modifier, while a long-range shot adds a +4 modifier. (These modifiers are listed above the range bracket columns on record sheets.) Weapons cannot hit a target beyond their long range.

For these Quick-Start Rules, this is usually the only factor that changes between weapons; if you run GATOR for one weapon, then simply change the Range Modifier, as needed, for any other weapon, instead of having to refigure the whole process.



Weapons Inventory				Range Modifiers		
				+0	+2	+4
Qty	Type	Loc	Dmg	Sht	Med	Lng
1	LB 10-X AC	LA	10	6	12	18
1	ER PPC	RA	15	7	14	23
1	LRM 15	LT	1/Msl	7	14	21

ATTACK MODIFIERS TABLE

All Attacks	Modifier
Gunnery Skill (GATOR)	Base Target Number
Attacker Movement Modifier (GATOR)	
Movement	
Stationary [White Movement Die, number 6 showing]	None
Walked [White Movement Die]	+1
Ran [Black Movement Die]	+2
Jumped [Red Movement Die]	+3
Target Movement Modifier (GATOR)	
Movement (highest applicable modifier only unless noted)	
Moved 0–2 hexes	0
Moved 3–4 hexes	+1
Moved 5–6 hexes	+2
Moved 7–9 hexes	+3
Moved 10+	+4
Jumped (cumulative with above)	+1
Terrain Modifiers (GATOR)	
Terrain	
Light Woods	+1 per intervening hex; +1 if target in light woods
Heavy Woods	+2 per intervening hex; +2 if target in heavy woods
Range Modifier (GATOR)	
Short	None
Medium	+2
Long	+4

CLUSTER HITS TABLE

Roll (2D6)	Weapon Size 2	4	5	6	10	15	20
2	1	1	1	2	3	5	6
3	1	2	2	2	3	5	6
4	1	2	2	3	4	6	9
5	1	2	3	3	6	9	12
6	1	2	3	4	6	9	12
7	1	3	3	4	6	9	12
8	2	3	3	4	6	9	12
9	2	3	4	5	8	12	16
10	2	3	4	5	8	12	16
11	2	4	5	6	10	15	20
12	2	4	5	6	10	15	20

EXAMPLE

The Rolling To Hit Diagram, page 7, illustrates how to determine a modified Target Number.

The Wolverine *has used its Running movement of 8 MP to move from Hex A to Hex B. Though it expended 8 MP in the move, it actually travelled five hexes, and so the player places a black Movement Die (because it ran) next to the* Wolverine *with a "2" showing (its target movement modifier).*

The Griffin *walked to get from Hex C to Hex D, placing the* Wolverine *in its Firing Arc. It spent a total of 5 MP but only travelled two hexes, and so a white Movement Die is placed next to the* Griffin *(because it walked) with a "6" showing (which means no target movement modifier).*

The Wolverine *is firing a medium laser and SRM 6 at the* Griffin *(they both have the same range, so even though they're different weapons, the player can figure the numbers simultaneously). The player remembers the* GATOR *principle as he begins to add up his numbers.*

The Base Target Number is the Wolverine *MechWarrior's Gunnery Skill of 4 (GATOR). The* Wolverine *used Running movement this turn, so its attacker movement modifier is +2; the black Movement Die (GATOR). The target moved, but not enough to receive a target movement modifier; its Movement Die shows a "6", meaning no modifier (GATOR). There is a light woods hex intervening along the LOS between the* Wolverine *and* Griffin*, which adds a +1 terrain modifier (GATOR). The target is four hexes away, which is in the medium range for the medium laser and SRM 6, adding a range modifier of +2 (GATOR). The result is a modified Target Number of 9 [4 (Gunnery Skill) + 2 (attacker movement) +0 (target movement) +1 (terrain modifier) + 2 (range modifier) = 9].*

The GRF-1N Griffin *is attacking back with its PPC. The* Griffin*'s MechWarrior's Gunnery Skill is 3 (this player is using a MechWarrior Card). The* Griffin *used Walking movement this turn, so it must add an attacker movement modifier of +1 (indicated by its white Movement Die). The target travelled five hexes, creating a +2 target movement modifier (the "2" on its Movement Die). There is a Light Woods hex intervening between the attacker and target along the LOS, and the target is in Light Woods, creating a +2 terrain modifier. The range to the target is four hexes, which is in short range for the PPC. For that attack, the modified Target Number is 8 [3 (Gunnery Skill) +1 (attacker movement) + 2 (target movement) +2 (terrain modifier) + 0 (range) = 8].*

ROLLING TO HIT

Once the player has determined the modified Target Number for each weapon their 'Mech is firing, they roll separately for each weapon to see if it hits.

For each weapon attack, the player rolls 2D6. If the result is equal to or greater than the modified Target Number, that attack succeeds.

Ultra Autocannons: If you roll a "2" for this weapon's attack roll when firing it at its double-rate, the weapon jams. The shots are still fired, but the weapon cannot be fired for the rest of the game.

Streak Missiles: Remember, if your attack with one of these weapons misses, don't mark off a shot (no ammunition is used).

DETERMINING HIT LOCATION

When an attack hits its target, the firing player must determine precisely where that attack struck.

To determine the location of a hit, the attacker rolls 2D6 and consults the Hit Location Table found on each 'Mech's record sheet (also found on p. 15).

Standard Missile Attacks: After each hit by a missile weapon, roll on the Cluster Hits Table above to determine the number of projectiles that actually hit the target. Use the column corresponding with the size of the launcher (the number in its name; e.g. a SRM 6 uses the "6" column).

For example, if you hit with an LRM-15, you then roll 2D6 and check the "15" column. A result of "9" means that 12 of the 15 missiles actually hit. The remaining 3 missiles are ignored.

- **SRM:** On a record sheet, the Damage column for short-range missiles (SRMs) lists them as "2/Msl", meaning two points of damage per missile. The attacker rolls a separate hit location for each SRM that hits. For example, a hit with 4 SRMs means four separate hit location rolls, with one missile hitting each of those locations.
- **LRM:** On a record sheet, the Damage column for long-range missiles (LRMs) lists them as "1/Msl", meaning one point of damage per missile. After determining how many LRMs hit the target from an attack, the attacker breaks that attack's damage up into groups of five; any leftover damage becomes its own undersized group. The attacker rolls a separate hit location for each of these LRM damage groupings (*not* each individual missile). For example, a hit with 12 LRMs means three separate hit location rolls: two 5-point Damage Value groupings, and one 2-point grouping.

Streak Missile Attacks: Unlike normal SRMs and LRMs, if a Streak missile launcher hits, skip the roll on the Cluster Hits Table. Instead, every missile in the attack hits the target. Resolve the hit locations per the normal rules for standard missile attacks given above (i.e. Streak SRMs still follow the usual hit location rules for standard SRMs).

Ultra Autocannons: If an ultra autocannon is fired twice in turn, the attacker still only makes one attack roll for it. If the attack hits, roll on the Cluster Hits Table, using the "2" column, to see if one or both rounds hit the target. If both rounds hit, make a separate hit location roll for each.

BATTLEMECH VARIANTS

Each BattleMech type is considered a unique chassis, but each chassis may have several variants developed over the centuries of war, boasting alternate weapons, equipment, or armor placement. For example, the *Wolverine* and *Griffin* both weigh 55 tons and are similar in speed, but are each a unique chassis with several variants.

Tech Base: Record sheets will note whether a 'Mech has an "Inner Sphere" or "Clan" Tech Base. At their heart, these Tech Bases indicate whether a machine was created by Inner Sphere forces or Clan forces. Beyond that, they have no significance at this rules level, but will come into play in more advanced products, such as the *BattleMech Manual*. They are included here to help familiarize players with all the details of a record sheet.

RECORDING DAMAGE

Each attack that hits the target does damage. Every weapon does a specific amount of damage, shown as the Damage Value (or Damage Value grouping) in the Weapons Inventory of each record sheet.

Damage checks off armor circles in a location (the number in parenthesis next to a location's name is its total armor). Follow the step-by-step procedure outlined in *Damage Resolution* (see below) to determine the effects of damage.

DAMAGE RESOLUTION

To apply damage, begin with the amount of damage inflicted and the hit location, and start at Step 1. Answer both questions yes or no, and follow the instructions.

1. Does the location have armor?

Yes: Check off one armor circle on the Armor Diagram in the appropriate location for every point of damage taken, until all damage is applied or all armor in the location is destroyed. If all armor in the location is destroyed, the location and any weapons mounted in it are destroyed. Regardless, go to Step 2.

No: Proceed to Step 2.



2. Is there damage remaining?

Yes: Damage transfers to the armor of the next location inward (see the Damage Transfer arrows on the Armor Diagram on each 'Mech record sheet). Go to Step 1 to allocate remaining damage.

No: Attack is finished.

TORSO DESTRUCTION

If a 'Mech's right or left torso has all of its Armor Points (circles) destroyed, the corresponding arm is blown off immediately and can sustain no further damage. The corresponding leg is not damaged. If the center torso is destroyed, the entire 'Mech is destroyed (see *Destroying a 'Mech*, below).

LEG DESTRUCTION

If one or both of a 'Mech's legs is destroyed, it cannot move nor make any facing changes for the rest of the game. It may fire weapons normally until it is completely destroyed, however (see *Destroying a 'Mech*, below).

TRANSFERRING DAMAGE

BattleMechs can survive the destruction of any body location except the head or center torso. If any other locations besides the center torso or head take further hits after being destroyed, or if excess damage remains from the shot that destroyed the location, that damage transfers to the armor of the next location inward.

This principle is illustrated with the Damage Transfer arrows on the Armor Diagram on each 'Mech record sheet. Damage to a missing arm or leg transfers to the torso on the same side; left leg or arm damage is transferred to the left torso, and right arm or leg damage to the right torso. Damage to a destroyed side torso location transfers to the center torso.

DESTROYING A 'MECH

A 'Mech is destroyed if its head or center torso is destroyed. Destroyed 'Mechs are removed from the map at the end of the phase in which they were destroyed, and have no further effect on play.

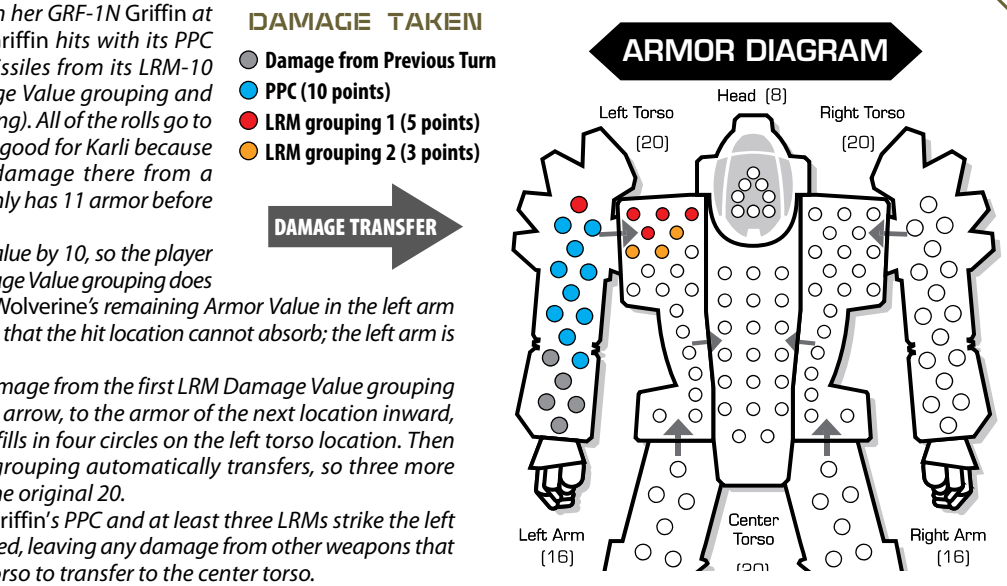
EXAMPLE

Karli declared an attack from her GRF-1N Griffin *at her opponent's* Wolverine. *The* Griffin *hits with its PPC (10 Damage Value) and eight missiles from its LRM-10 (grouped into one 5-point Damage Value grouping and one 3-point Damage Value grouping). All of the rolls go to the* Wolverine*'s left arm, which is good for Karli because there was already 5 points of damage there from a previous turn, meaning the arm only has 11 armor before this current attack.*

The PPC reduces the Armor Value by 10, so the player fills in ten circles. The first LRM Damage Value grouping does 5 points of damage, but since the Wolverine*'s remaining Armor Value in the left arm is 1, that leaves 4 points of damage that the hit location cannot absorb; the left arm is completely destroyed.*

The remaining 4 points of damage from the first LRM Damage Value grouping transfer, per the Damage Transfer arrow, to the armor of the next location inward, which is the left torso. The player fills in four circles on the left torso location. Then the final 3-point Damage Value grouping automatically transfers, so three more circles are filled in, leaving 13 of the original 20.

In a subsequent turn, if the Griffin*'s PPC and at least three LRMs strike the left torso (or left arm), it will be destroyed, leaving any damage from other weapons that may have hit the left arm or left torso to transfer to the center torso.*



SCENARIO

This training scenario recreates one of the many "greenhorn" simulator programs used to train burgeoning MechWarriors throughout the Inner Sphere.

Both Players Roll 2D6: the winner is the attacker and places their 'Mech on the mapsheet after the loser has placed their 'Mech.

GAME SET-UP

Lay out the Desert #1 mapsheet provided with these rules.

DEFENDER

Cut out the appropriate counter and GRF-1N *Griffin* record sheet for use in the game. Player may substitute this with any *Clan Invasion Salvage Box* 'Mech after consulting *Clan Invasion Salvage Box 'Mechs* (see below, under *Variations*).

DEPLOYMENT

The defending player sets up first, placing their 'Mech anywhere within 3 hexes of the south edge (short end) of the mapsheet.

ATTACKER

Cut out the appropriate counter and WVR-6R *Wolverine* record sheet for use in the game. Player may substitute this with any *Clan Invasion Salvage Box* 'Mech after consulting *Clan Invasion Salvage Box 'Mechs* (see below, under *Variations*).

DEPLOYMENT

The attacking player may place their 'Mech on any of the hexes along the north edge (short end) of the mapsheet.

VICTORY CONDITIONS

Victory belongs to the first side to destroy the enemy 'Mech.

If a 'Mech exits the map for any reason, it is considered destroyed. In this instance, unless the opponent's 'Mech is destroyed in the same turn, the opponent will automatically win.

Now play your first game!

VARIATIONS

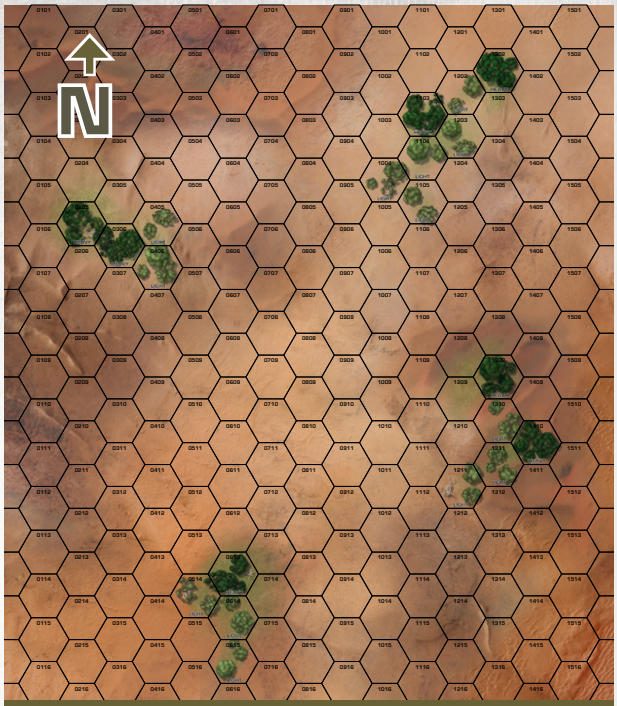
You've now got your first game under your belt and you're ready to tackle more. *BattleTech* is wonderfully flexible in allowing players to quickly mix and match maps, 'Mechs, and other elements for endless games. Use the following ideas for additional variations on the scenario above, then feel free to try and build your own.

Clan Invasion Salvage Box 'Mechs: You can add BattleMechs from your *Clan Invasion Salvage Boxes* to your force. Follow the guidelines for *Force Balance* on page 12. All Salvage Box QSR Record Sheets are available for download at: **bg.battletech.com/qsr**.

Playing With Multiple 'Mechs: There are slight rules modifications when using more than one 'Mech on a side (see *Playing With Multiple 'Mechs,* at right).

MECHWARRIOR CARDS

Many *BattleTech* products feature MechWarrior Cards, which bring notable MechWarriors from the fiction to life. After you have one scenario under your belt, consider adding any cards you might have to your game. Use the following rules when doing so:



• DESERT #1 MAP LAYOUT •

PLAYING WITH MULTIPLE 'MECHS

When there are multiple 'Mechs on a side, use the following modifications to the standard rules:

Movement Phase (p. 2): The side that lost Initiative chooses a 'Mech and moves it first. The side that won Initiative then moves a 'Mech. Movement alternates between sides until all 'Mechs have been moved. Each time a player must move a 'Mech, they may designate movement for any 'Mech that has not been destroyed, even if the "move" is to simply do nothing.

Stacking (p. 4): During the Movement Phase, a 'Mech may move through hexes occupied by other friendly 'Mechs.

Weapon Attack Phase (p. 4): The side that lost Initiative chooses a 'Mech and declares any attacks it will make, specifying which weapons will be fired and at which target(s).

The side that won Initiative then does the same.

The act of declaring attacks alternates between sides until all fire has been declared. Each time a player must declare an attack, they may do so for any 'Mech that has not been destroyed, even if the declaration is to do nothing.

Finally, all declared attacks must be resolved, even if the intended target is destroyed before all attacks against it have been resolved.

Multiple Targets: A 'Mech cannot declare weapon attacks against more than one target in the same turn.

- Only one BattleMech per side can have an attached MechWarrior Card.
- Both MechWarrior Cards should have the same Special Pilot Abilities cost.

Force Balance: As noted above, both MechWarrior Cards should have the same Special Pilot Abilities cost, so both players will need to agree on that cost prior to the game. If you cannot agree, roll a D6. This is the maximum Special Pilot Abilities cost allowed for that game.

If you're using a MechWarrior Card, replace the Gunnery Skill listed in the scenario entry for the one on the card. However, to maintain force balance, an opposing MechWarrior should have their Gunnery Skill Rating improved (i.e., lowered) by the same increment as the bonus provided by the MechWarrior Card. For example, if a MechWarrior Card would lower a unit's rating from Gunnery Skill 4 to Gunnery Skill 3, an opposing MechWarrior could improve their Gunnery Skill of 5 by one level, to Gunnery Skill 4.

Gunnery Skills: All MechWarrior Cards include Gunnery Skills. If the listed skill is lower than 4, use the value listed on the card during game play.

Piloting Skills: These ratings allow players to use these cards once they've moved on to the *BattleTech: A Game of Armored Combat* box set. They have no effect in the Quick-Start Rules.



• MECHWARRIOR CARD •



FIND US ONLINE:
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(official BattleTech web pages)
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BATTLETECH

'MECH RECORD SHEET

'MECH DATA

Type: Griffin GRF-1N

Movement Points:
Walking: 5
Running: 8
Jumping: 5

Tonnage: 55
Weight Class: Medium
Tech Base:
Inner Sphere

Weapons Inventory

Qty	Type	Loc	Dmg	Range Modifiers +0 Sht	+2 Med	+4 Lng
1	LRM 10	RT	1/Msl	7	14	21
1	PPC	RA	10	6	12	18

Ammo Type	Shots
LRM 10	12

'MECH HIT LOCATIONS

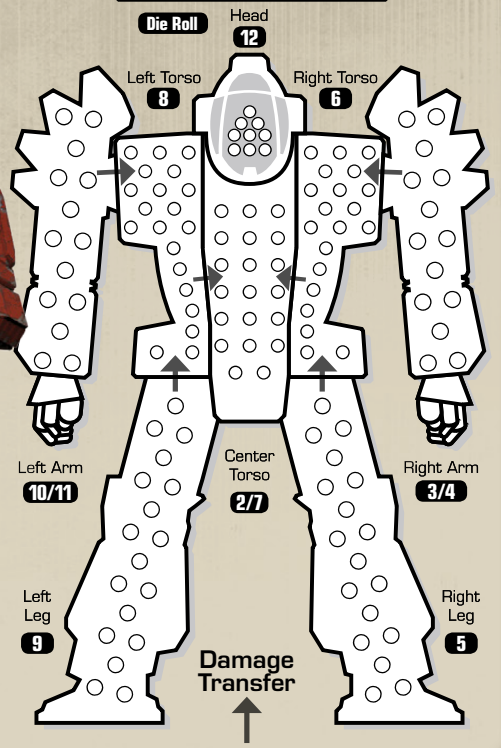
2D6	Location	2D6	Location
2	Center Torso	8	Left Torso
3	Right Arm	9	Left Leg
4	Right Arm	10	Left Arm
5	Right Leg	11	Left Arm
6	Right Torso	12	Head
7	Center Torso		



MECHWARRIOR DATA

Gunnery Skill: 4

ARMOR DIAGRAM



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BATTLETECH

'MECH RECORD SHEET

'MECH DATA

Type: Wolverine WVR-6R

Movement Points:
Walking: 5
Running: 8
Jumping: 5

Tonnage: 55
Weight Class: Medium
Tech Base:
Inner Sphere

Weapons Inventory

Qty	Type	Loc	Dmg	Range Modifiers +0 Sht	+2 Med	+4 Lng
1	Medium Laser	HD	5	3	6	9
1	SRM 6	LT	2/Msl	3	6	9
1	AC/5	RA	5	6	12	18

Ammo Type	Shots
AC/5	20
SRM 6	15

'MECH HIT LOCATIONS

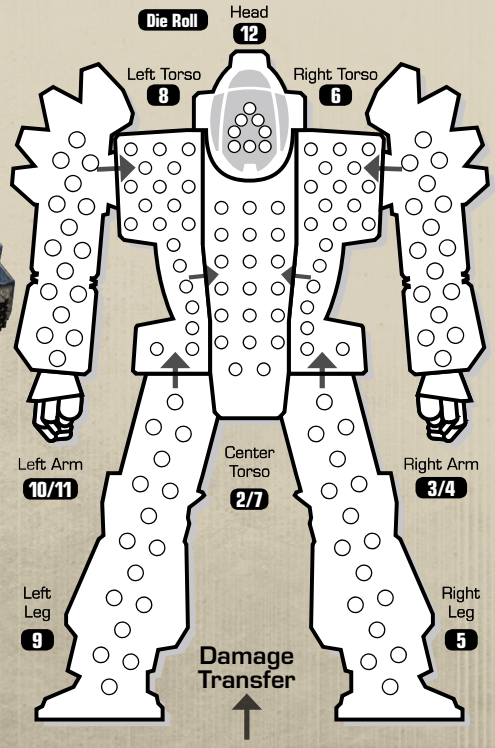
2D6	Location	2D6	Location
2	Center Torso	8	Left Torso
3	Right Arm	9	Left Leg
4	Right Arm	10	Left Arm
5	Right Leg	11	Left Arm
6	Right Torso	12	Head
7	Center Torso		



MECHWARRIOR DATA

Gunnery Skill: 4

ARMOR DIAGRAM



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SEQUENCE OF PLAY

Initiative Phase
Movement Phase
Weapon Attack Phase

G.A.T.O.R.

- **G** Gunnery Skill Rating of the attacker (the base Target Number for the attack). Then add:
- **A** Attacker movement modifier [the color of the Movement Die on your 'Mech]
- **T** Target movement modifier [the number of the Movement die on the target 'Mech]
- **O** Other modifiers (for this box, just Terrain)
- **R** Range modifiers

MOVEMENT COSTS TABLE

Movement Action/Terrain Type	MP Cost Per Hex/ Terrain Cost
Cost to Enter Any Hex	1
Terrain Cost When Entering Any New Hex	
Clear	+0
Light Woods	+1
Heavy Woods	+2
Additional Movement Actions	
Facing Change	1/hexside

ATTACK MODIFIERS TABLE

All Attacks	Modifier
Gunnery Skill (GATOR)	Base Target Number
Attacker Movement Modifier (GATOR)	
Movement	
Stationary [White Movement Die, number 6 showing]	None
Walked [White Movement Die]	+1
Ran [Black Movement Die]	+2
Jumped [Red Movement Die]	+3
Target Movement Modifier (GATOR)	
Movement (highest applicable modifier only unless noted)	
Moved 0–2 hexes	0
Moved 3–4 hexes	+1
Moved 5–6 hexes	+2
Moved 7–9 hexes	+3
Moved 10+	+4
Jumped (cumulative with above)	+1
Terrain Modifiers (GATOR)	
Terrain (modifiers are cumulative)	
Light Woods	+1 per intervening hex; +1 if target in light woods
Heavy Woods	+2 per intervening hex; +2 if target in heavy woods
Range Modifier (GATOR)	
Short	None
Medium	+2
Long	+4

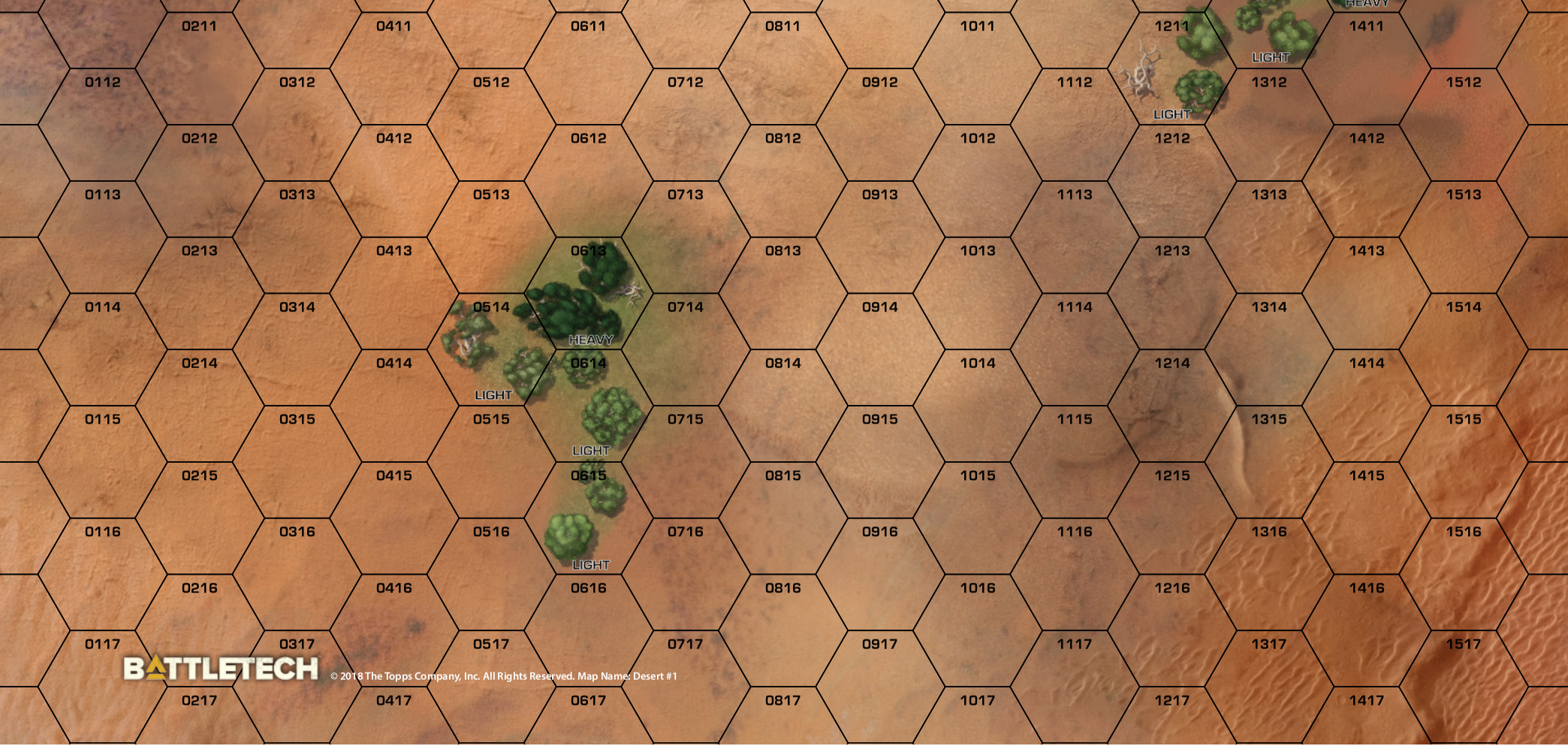
HIT LOCATION TABLE

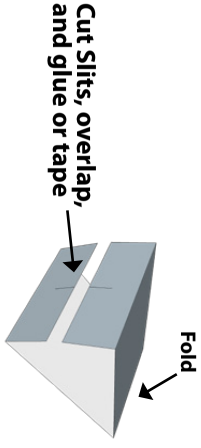
Roll (2D6)	Location
2	Center Torso
3	Right Arm
4	Right Arm
5	Right Leg
6	Right Torso
7	Center Torso
8	Left Torso
9	Left Leg
10	Left Arm
11	Left Arm
12	Head

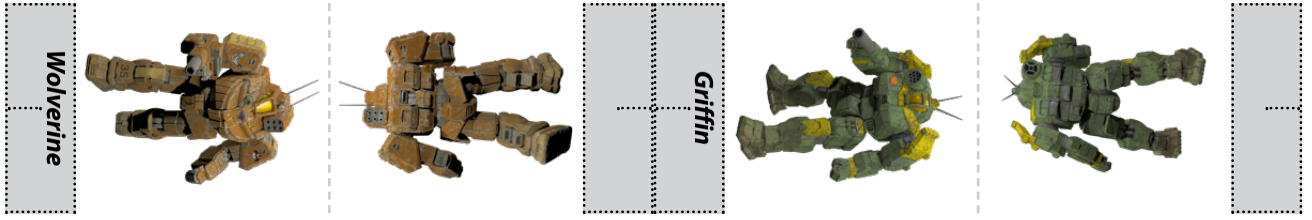
CLUSTER HITS TABLE

Roll	Weapon Size						
(2D6)	2	4	5	6	10	15	20
2	1	1	1	2	3	5	6
3	1	2	2	2	3	5	6
4	1	2	2	3	4	6	9
5	1	2	3	3	6	9	12
6	1	2	3	4	6	9	12
7	1	3	3	4	6	9	12
8	2	3	3	4	6	9	12
9	2	3	4	5	8	12	16
10	2	3	4	5	8	12	16
11	2	4	5	6	10	15	20
12	2	4	5	6	10	15	20


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BATTLETECH
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0217
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1017
1217
1417


Cut Slits, overlap, and glue or tape
Fold


Wolverine
Griffin